

OnePlus Buds Pro 3

A sound investment

The OnePlus Buds Pro 3 is the latest addition to the brand's growing lineup of true wireless earbuds. Known for offering high-end features at competitive prices, OnePlus has pushed the envelope further with this new offering. The Buds Pro 3 not only flaunts a redesigned aesthetic but also promises significant improvements in sound quality and Active Noise Cancellation (ANC). However, the competition is fierce in a market crowded with formidable contenders like the OPPO Enco X2, Nothing Ear (2024), and Moto Buds+.

The OnePlus Buds Pro 3 are aimed at audiophiles and everyday users alike, offering a mix of high-fidelity sound, intelligent features, and extended battery life. While OnePlus has always been good at delivering quality hardware, the question remains: have they managed to improve their audio experience alongside the design makeover? In this review, we'll break down the OnePlus Buds Pro 3's build, features, performance, and more to help you decide if these earbuds are worth your hard-earned money.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The OnePlus Buds Pro 3 takes a new approach with its design, departing from the suitcase-like case of its predecessor in favour of a pebble-shaped case. This change aligns the Buds Pro 3 with its sister company OPPO's TWS earphones, offering a more ergonomic and compact form factor. What really sets the design apart, though, is the faux leather texture that adorns the front and back of the case. This not only enhances the look but also adds a tactile element that makes the Buds Pro 3 feel more premium.



It's important to note that the faux leather is actually plastic and not actual leather or vegan leather. While the material choice might not scream luxury, it's a step in the right direction for those looking for something a little more stylish in their everyday tech. The case also features a metallic-look circumference with a matte finish, adding to the sleek and minimalist aesthetic OnePlus is known for. Available in two colours—Midnight Opus and Lunar Radiance—the Buds Pro 3 case sports an LED indicator at the bottom for charging status, along with a discreet pairing button on the side.

However, the case is on the heavier side, even more so than the Sony WF-1000XM4, which could be a drawback for those who prefer something lightweight and pocketable. The earbuds themselves follow a matte and glossy finish combination, which exudes a

premium vibe. The fit is excellent, providing a secure and comfortable experience, though the pressure controls could offer a bit more tactile feedback.

FEATURES

OnePlus has packed the Buds Pro 3 with an array of features that cater to both casual listeners and audiophiles. Nearly every modern feature you'd expect from a TWS in 2024 is present, ensuring that the Buds Pro 3 remain competitive in a crowded market. The companion app, HeyMelody, available on both Android and iOS, provides a hub for these features, allowing users to customise their experience to a significant degree.

One of the standout features is the Active Noise Cancellation (ANC), which is impressive for the price point. OnePlus has significantly improved the ANC quality over previous iterations, even outperforming competitors like the Nothing Ear (2024) and the OPPO Enco X2. Human voices and ambient sounds are effectively silenced, making these buds ideal for noisy environments. Users can choose between manual ANC settings or engage Adaptive ANC, which automatically adjusts the level of noise cancellation based on the surrounding environment.

Another noteworthy feature is the inclusion of a 6-band equaliser, allowing users to tweak the sound profile to their liking. Additionally, there's a BassWave slider that enhances the bass response, although cranking it up too high can lead to muddiness in the sound. Spatial Audio is another prominent feature, with OnePlus switching to Google's Spatial Audio technology. While Spatial Audio with Head Tracking can introduce some distortion, the Fixed setting doesn't face the same issue, and offers a wide soundstage, making for a more immersive listening experience.

The Buds Pro 3 also comes equipped with other modern features like Multipoint or Dual Connection, which lets you connect the earbuds to two devices simultaneously. There's also an Earbud Fit Test to ensure the perfect fit for optimal sound quality. Google Fast Pair,